The Roxburgh Ramble

2003 New Zealand Rogaining Championships 15 -16 March 2003

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS TO COMPETITORS. **YOUR TEAM NUMBER IS** _____

Please ensure all your team members read this document. It contains important information. Thank you for your entry in the Roxburgh Ramble. This information is sent to the team leader only so please copy it to all other members of your team. A copy is also available on the New Zealand Rogaine Association website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz . Attached are Indemnity and Emergency contact forms to be completed by all members of your team and to be handed in at registration. See the website for a list of competitors and up-to-date information.

Acknowledgements

We are indebted to all the landowners who have so willingly allowed us to use their land.

Jim & Sally Barclay
Pat & Marcelle Garden
Eoin & Noeline Garden
Kevin Watson & Brenda Hall
Alan & Jean Hore
Peter & Geraldine Macdougal
Gray & Robin Pannett
Anthony & Wendy Rowley
James & Kate Whyte
Peter & Valerie Cubitt
Alan & Hillary Garden
Tony Gillespie
Dick & Ann Hill
John Kerr
Dougal & Sarah Macdougall
Norman & Lisa ROOS
Ross & Mary Watson
David Wright, Brian & Maxine Wright

We also greatly appreciate the contributions made by the Roxburgh Lions for their catering, to the NZ Land S.A.R team from Roxburgh, and to the many others who have assisted us in so many ways.

Organisers' Contact Details

The organisers may be contacted by telephone or email.

Bill Kennedy Phone: 03 337 0364 Email:Kennedyz@xtra.co.nz
Tom Barnfield Phone: 027 454 2403

For **emergency only**, during the event, contact the event centre on 025 285 0344

Directions to the Site

The event headquarters is at the Minzion Station Woolshed, near Roxburgh on the Clutha river. It is about 500 kms from Christchurch, 150 kms from Queenstown, and 200 kms from Dunedin.

From Alexandra, follow State Highway 8 across the Clutha river towards Roxburgh. You will pass through Roxburgh village, then a bit later through Roxburgh itself. Continue on the main road for about 12 kms to Ettrick. 4 kms past the end of Ettrick there is a blue bridge (opposite the "Bridge Tavern" on the right) crossing north-east across the Clutha river to Millers Flat.

From Dunedin, head south along State Highway 1 to Milton. Just past Milton turn right onto State Highway 8 to Lawrence, Roxburgh, Alexandra, Cromwell, and Queenstown. At Beaumont you cross to the west side of the Clutha River and continue a few kilometers to Raes Junction where you continue (still on State Highway 8) towards Roxburgh, Alexandra

etc. After about another 14 to 15 kms you will find a blue bridge on a side road to your right, which crosses the Clutha river to Millers Flat.

At Millers Flat turn left and proceed northwest for 1.5 kms towards Roxburgh until you find the Tima Burn Road branching off on the right. Follow this road for about 3 kms, where the Minzion Road forks off to the right. Follow this road for about 6 kms to the Minzion Station Woolshed, leaving gates as you found them. The grid reference is 363 021 on topomap G43 of the 1:50,000 series

Rogaine direction signs will be in place from midday Friday from the Millers Flat bridge across the Clutha.

Daylight Saving.

Officially, we should set our clocks back by one hour at 2:00 am on Sunday, as NZ goes from Daylight saving to normal time. Do *NOT* do this during the event. All times given here assume no alteration to clocks until after 3:00 pm on Sunday.

Camping at the Minzion Station Woolshed:

There are adequate camping sites close to the start-finish area and available from Friday through Sunday nights. Please camp only in the area provided which will be clearly signposted. Water and toilets will be provided. You will need to be completely self-sufficient, including your own Rubbish Bags. Any cooking must be done with gas-fuelled stoves. Note that fires, smoking, dogs, and guns are not permitted anywhere at the Rogaine venue – campsite, administration area, and course.
See the website at
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/Events/RoxburghInfo.htm#Accommodation for alternative accommodation.
Important Note: If you are a competitor **and** the driver of a car please have sufficient sleep before heading home. The campsite is open all Sunday night for this purpose. Australian clubs have had many instances of people falling asleep at the wheel so please take care.

Event Timetable

Friday 14th March

4:00 pm	Camping available at the Minzion Station Woolshed
7:30 pm to 9:00 pm	Registration open
8:00pm	NZRA Annual meeting

Sat 15th March

8:00am	Registration open
9:00am	Maps available on presentation of map ticket
9:30am	Novice instruction.
11:45am	Compulsory briefing, and Punch Cards available
12:01 pm	Mass start
6:00pm	Catering opens at the Minzion Station Woolshed.
6:49 pm	Moonrise
8:06 pm	Sunset

Sun 16th March

04:00 am	Moonset
07:39 am	Sunrise
11:00 am.	Catering stops
12:01 pm	Event finishes
12:30 pm	Lunch Banquet starts.
2:00 pm	Catering closes
3:00 pm	Set your watches back 1 hour to end NZ Daylight Saving

Mon 17th March

9:00am Camping closes

Food will be available at the administration area continuously between 6pm Saturday and 11:00 am Sunday, and again after 12:30 pm on Sunday.

Map and Course

The map is A3 in size, is pre-marked with the checkpoint positions, and has out-of-bounds areas overprinted. It is vertically oriented to magnetic north (22 degrees east of true north) and is based on the standard 1:50,000 topographical series, with 20 m contours. Grid lines 1 km apart show true North and East. A few magnetic north gridlines will be pre-marked on the map. Some pictures of the area are available on our website, www.rogaine.org.nz . There will be one map per competitor. You will need to bring a plastic bag or contact covering as the map is not waterproof. There is NO LEGEND on the map, but one will be posted on the event noticeboard.

The terrain is rolling spur-gully farmland, a mix of grazed pasture and open tussock grassland with a few forestry plantations. Although the altitude ranges from 80 to 1000 metres, most of the area is above 300 metres and there is a surprising amount of relatively flat travel available to those who choose their routes appropriately, with the start-finish area already at 600 metres. See the planners report and pictures on the website. Any updated information on the course will be posted on a notice board near the registration desk.

There will be four water drops on the course. Please use this water for drinking only and do not waste it. Note that there will be a full moon.

Route Intention map

You will find a black-and-white map of the Rogaine, reduced to A4 size, in your registration pack. After you plan your course, mark it out on this map, including the direction you will go and your estimated nightfall and daybreak places. It is a "flight plan" to give the event organisers an indication of where you might be found if a search becomes necessary. You do not have to stick to the route you have specified; it is an indication only. Place the completed map in a box that will be provided at the registration desk. Don't forget to put your team number on it.

Fences, tracks, and Out-of-Bounds areas.

There are areas of deer farm, which are marked as out-of-bounds. There are also other deer fences which are NOT part of a deer enclosure. You may cross these fences, either by crawling under them at a low point, or by finding a gate and going through. I strongly recommend the gate option.

As usual, tracks and fences exist which are not marked on the map, and others are marked but no longer exist. In many cases they serve as useful navigational aids, but you must not assume their accuracy without other supporting information, such as contours.

There are some electric fences, particularly in the south-western part of the map. Use your map (in its plastic bag) to hold the wires down while you cross them. The fences in the south-eastern corner, and generally in the tussock country, will be off.

Weather and Equipment

There are 7 days in March (on average) with rainfall at least 1.0 mm. The mean daily max. temp. is 21C, and the mean daily min. temp is 8C.

This is an area exposed to the south. While normally fine in March with temperatures into the twenties during daytime, there are cold nights. There is the possibility of very cold wind and rain at any time, and snow can fall in March. Much of the area has little natural protection and you must ensure that you are well prepared with plenty of spare clothing.

A suggested minimum list is:

Polypropylene or woollen top and trousers.
A heavy waterproof parka.
Gaiters or leggings.
Food.
Water bottle (2 litres minimum).
A whistle each.
A basic first-aid kit for the team,
A warm hat and mitts.
An extra jersey or fleece top.
Torches, and batteries for 12 hours.
A compass and pencil.
Suitable shoes or boots with a good grip.
A daypack
A large (A3) plastic bag, or some clear plastic stick-on covering to protect your map.

The north-eastern half of the map in particular is open tussock grassland, above 700 metres, and exposed to winds from any direction. People going there should carry heavy waterproof parkas, windproof trousers, and a thick thermal top and hat in addition to their normal polypropylene layers. If the weather packs up, you will have to walk into a headwind for several hours to get home, and sleet is a distinct possibility.

If you are in any doubt about the suitability of your equipment, *please* ask an organiser.

You should expect to get wet feet, although you will be able to cover large distances without having to cross streams. There are many mossy areas and many small watercourses hidden in the tussock, and there will almost certainly be heavy dew overnight.

Other Gear

You must bring a plate and cup, plus knife, fork, and spoon, for eating at the start-finish area. Bring toilet paper. There will be NO rubbish facilities so you MUST bring your own rubbish bag. A tent and sleeping bag are essential if you think you might stop overnight. Chairs and a table are also useful for planning your route. There will be a limited area available within covered sheepyards and you can use your chairs and tables there if you are early enough; otherwise you should use your tent or car for planning.

Emergency

Blow your whistle (six blasts at one second intervals, repeated every few minutes) to assist any other team to find you. If you have a cell phone, call `025 285 0344`. Any team hearing the emergency call must respond and render assistance to the team that is in distress.

Registration and Start Procedure

Your team (one member is adequate) should present a completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form at the registration desk. Make sure you have entered your team number on the form. If no money is owing, the team will be issued with checkpoint descriptions, chits for maps, and any last minute course notes. (Any money owing must be paid before map chits will be issued. Correct change would be appreciated). Any changes in team composition must be advised.

Tickets ($2 each) for a hot shower on Sunday at Millers Flat Holiday Park will be for sale. This is the nearest available hot shower, it is very close to any route home, and is an excellent facility. Purchasing a ticket will ensure that there will be enough hot water for you.

At 9am maps will be handed out in return for the chits. Each team must also ensure they pick up a “flight plan” map. Plan your route and complete the “flight plan” map, which must be placed in the box provided at the administration desk.

You must attend the compulsory briefing for all competitors that will be held at 11:45 am. Score cards will be available at this time. These are made of tough plasticised paper that will not tear when wet, so do not require protection by use of "contact". At 12:01 pm, when the start signal is given, off you go.

If you have never been in a Rogaine before, novice instruction will be available at 9:30 am.

Scoring during the Event

There are 72 checkpoints, each numbered between 21 and 95, with a total value of 3780 points. The checkpoint value is the “tens” value of its number, so for example 37 is worth 30 points, 53 is worth 50 points. Each checkpoint is marked on the map as a 7mm diameter black circle, with the checkpoint number beside it.

There is a Late penalty of 10 points per minute or part thereof after 12:01 pm Sunday. Disqualification will occur after 12:31 pm which means no score at all.

You must carry a pencil with you to fill in the intentions sheet at each checkpoint.
When you visit a check point punch your score-card in the **correct** square and fill in the intention sheet, recording your team number, the time and next check point you intend to visit. The only accepted evidence of a check-point visit is a legible punch mark on your score card. If you lose your score-card punch marks on a single sheet will be accepted as evidence a check point has been visited. Some experienced rogainers will punch the edge of one of their maps at each checkpoint in addition to the punch card. They also attach a piece of string through the hole in the card, and tie it to their wrist.

All team members must visit each checkpoint you claim, to within 20 metres and in sight of it. The checkpoints are marked by a three-sided cloth flag, coloured white and orange.
You must not stop at a checkpoint any longer than you need to complete the requirements. If you want to stop for a rest or a discussion, you must move to at least 100 metres away from the checkpoint.

Here is a copy of the waterproof clipcard your team will get just before the start.

s	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29		Team	Class	s
30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39		91		s
40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49		92		s
50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59		93	Finish time:	s
60	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69		94		s
s	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79		95		s
s	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89			Score:	s

Copy only

The squares marked with dark borders must be left untouched. If you punch the wrong square at a checkpoint, re-punch the correct square and tell an organizer when you finish. If you later need to punch a square which has already been incorrectly punched, punch one of the ten spare squares (marked "s") and again, tell an organizer when you finish. If your team returns to the Minzion Station Woolshed during the event your score card **must** be handed in to the administration desk. Collect it again immediately before departure.

Finish Procedure

When you finish, hand your score card to the administration staff. Your entire team must finish together, a finish time will be only be recorded when all members are present. You will be given a blank copy of the scorecard, on which you may cross the checkpoints you have visited and calculate your own score. If you resubmit this card by 12:30 pm we will use it to check our own calculation; otherwise, our results are final. *We urge you to do this.* The penalty for finishing late is 10 points per minute.

Protests

Reports of breaches of the rules, or protests against the event organisers, will be considered and determined by a three person jury. Such protests must be lodged in writing within 15 minutes of the end of the event. The jury panel for the Championships shall be selected from members of the NZRA committee and NZRA regional contacts, members of the NZOF Rogaining committee, and recognized rogainers. It will exclude the course planner and vetter, who may however be consulted by the jury. The fee for lodging a protest is $20 which will be refunded if judgement is in your favour.

Rules of Competition

The New Zealand Championship will be run under the standard competition rules developed by the Australian Rogaining Association and which are available in full at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/Ozrules.htm . A copy of the rules will be on the Notice Board at the event.

The following is an outline of some of the important rules:

- No fires are to be lit anywhere on the course, this includes the camping area, and the administration area.
- Competitors shall not discard litter or smoke on the course.
- The only navigational aids that may be carried on the course are magnetic compasses, watches and copies of the competition map. The possession of other navigational aids, including pedometers, altimeters and GPS receivers on the course is prohibited. The possession of non-competition maps is prohibited at the event venue.
- Members of a team shall remain within unaided verbal contact of one another at all times whilst on the course. A team shall demonstrate compliance with this requirement to any event official or other team on request.
- All team members shall simultaneously approach to within 20 metres, and within sight, of each checkpoint for which points are claimed.

The following is a modification of the standard rule for this event only:

- Teams that wish to split through injury or tiredness may do so at one of the manned checkpoints or at the base, and may continue their course without restarting. (see rule 22). Such teams which do not restart will become “informal”, rather than being "disqualified". Their final score will be listed separately from the Official results, and they will not be eligible for any placing.

Definitions.

A watercourse is marked with a blue line on the map. In most cases there is water in them and they could be called streams. However to be consistent with standard definitions we have called them watercourses.

A gully is where a stream could be if there was enough rain. Orienteers call these “re-entrants”. In many cases these gullies do have water in them, but because there is no blue line on the map, we call them gullies instead.

A ridge is like a long, stretched-out hill top, which you can walk along for a considerable distance without gaining or losing much height, but which you can walk downhill quickly on either side of.

A spur is a short, usually steep ridge, often running down from a bigger ridge.

A saddle is a low-point in a ridge.

In Rogaining, there is a distinction between “the” and “a”. “The” watercourse means you can see it marked as a watercourse on the map, whereas “a” watercourse means that one exists, but it isn’t marked on the map.

TEAM NUMBER: _____

The Roxburgh Ramble 15th – 16th March 2003

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following forms have been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity
We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organisers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.